

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Count Sure Winners				
				Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 5♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K 4 2
♥ 5 2
♦ 9 8 3 2
♣ A 7 6 3

♠ A 6 3
♥ K Q 10 9 6 4
♦ A K J
♣ 8



♠ 10 9 8 7
♥ A
♦ 10 6 5
♣ J 9 5 4 2

♠ Q J 5
♥ J 8 7 3
♦ Q 7 4
♣ K Q 10

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♥		
All Pass			

5♥ by North

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

You have a very good hand. But not good enough to open 2♣, so you open 1♥.

Partner jumps to 3♥.

This is close. Partner has 11 or 12 points and good ♥ support. Your hand revalues to 21 points. You might have a slam. You decide to try for it and bid 4NT. Partner replies 5♣ showing no Aces. So much for the slam. You bid 5♥.

North plays 5♥. East leads the ♠10. You put on dummy's ♠J, West plays the ♠K and you win the ♠A.

North plays 5♥. East leads the ♠T. You put on dummy's ♠J, West plays the ♠K and you win the ♠A.

You cannot avoid losing either of the two Aces. So therefore you must do something about the ♠ loser. And the only thing you can do with it is to discard it on one of dummy's ♣s.

Be careful. If you lead a trump now a defender will take the Ace and play another ♠, exposing your loser while the ♣A is still out. You must set up the ♣ first. So at trick 2 play your ♣ to dummy's ♣Q. A defender may win this and play a ♠, but you win the ♠Q and play the ♣K, discarding your ♠ loser. Now you switch to trumps.

The way you decide whether to start pulling trumps right away is to use your imagination.

Imagine what the defense will do if you lead a round of trumps. Then imagine what they will do if you play a different suit instead.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6 3
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 7 5 3
♣ 10 5 4

♠ K 10 9 8

♥ 9 6 3

♦ Q J 4

♣ 9 7 2



♠ Q J 7 4
♥ A K
♦ 10 8 6 2
♣ A K Q

♠ 5 2

♥ Q J 10 8 4

♦ K 9

♣ J 8 6 3

West	North	East	South
2♦	Pass	1♦	Pass
All Pass		3NT	

3NT by East

This is one of the most misplayed positions in bridge. The usual approach is to lead the ♠Q, hoping that South holds the ♠K. But this can't succeed. If South does hold the ♠K he will cover, either this trick or the ♠J, and someone's ♠10 will become a winner. Of course if North has the ♠K then the finesse will fail, along with your chance of 2 more winners.

The correct way to play for 2 more tricks is to hope **NORTH** has the ♠K and lead twice toward your ♠Q J. So win the first trick, play ♠4 to dummy's ♠A. Lead the ♠3 toward your hand, playing the ♠J if North plays low. (Of course if North ever plays the ♠K he gives you two winners immediately.) When the ♠J wins, return to dummy with the ♦A and lead the ♠6 toward your ♠Q.

When North holds the ♠K you can always get 3 ♠ tricks if you play correctly.

With 19 points you are too strong to open 1NT so you open 1♦. Partner responds 2♦.

Perhaps you can make 5♦. But 9 tricks are easier than 11 so you bid 3NT. Notice that there was no reason to "show" your ♠ suit. If partner held 4 ♠s he would not have bid 2♦.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥Q.

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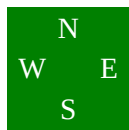
Winners: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 7

You can create one winner in ♦s if they split 3-2, but too late, the defense would have set up their ♥s. So you must get 2 more ♠ tricks.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 10 2
♥ 10 8 4
♦ J 10 9 3
♣ Q 10 5

♠ 6 4
♥ A 7 3
♦ K Q 5 4
♣ A K 8 2



♠ K 5
♥ J 9 5 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ 9 7 6 3

♠ Q J 9 8 7 3
♥ K Q 6
♦ 7 2
♣ J 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

West wins with an honor and probably plays the ♦ 10. Ruff it, lead a ♣ to dummy and lead the last ♠. If East plays the other high honor you play low. If East plays low you guess whether to play the ♠ K, or ♠ 10. Your best play is to assume the two honors were split and play the ♠ Q.

Leading twice toward the ♠ Q J gives you a guarantee on this layout because East held a doubleton high honor.

Now

Here West has taken your ♠ J with the ♠ A. When you again lead a small ♠ from dummy say that East plays the ♠ 5.

You might think that West is just as likely to have held an original doubleton ♠ A K as doubleton ♠ A 10, and that playing the ♠ 9 would be as good a play as ♠ Q.

This is untrue for a very classy-named reason - **The Principle of Restricted Choice**. You may not even believe it when you read it, but it's mathematically sound. If West were dealt an original ♠ A K, he would have been just as likely to win with the ♠ K as with the ♠ A. The fact that he actually won the ♠ A makes it less likely that he also holds the ♠ K.

HE WHO KNOWS, GOES You **KNOW** your side has 26-28 points. You **KNOW** your side has 8 or more ♠s. You **GO** to 4♠.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♦ J.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♦ J.

Losers: ♠ 2/3 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 3/4

You are definitely going to lose the ♦ A and the ♠ A K. Therefore you must plan to avoid losing a third ♠.

You should lead **UP TO** your honor cards. Cover the ♦ J and lose to East's ♦ A. Win his return (probably another ♦) in dummy. Lead a small ♠ to your ♠ J.